



French woodcutter This 13th-century peasant is wrapped up against the cold in a large wool coat over a red tunic. Leather shoes help to keep his feet warm and dry. The painted colours are not true to life.



Sieneese country man An Italian 1380s fresco shows warm-weather country clothing – cool, loose linen *braies* (drawers) over bare legs, a wool tunic open at the neck and tucked back to reveal a long linen shirt, and a wide-brimmed straw hat.



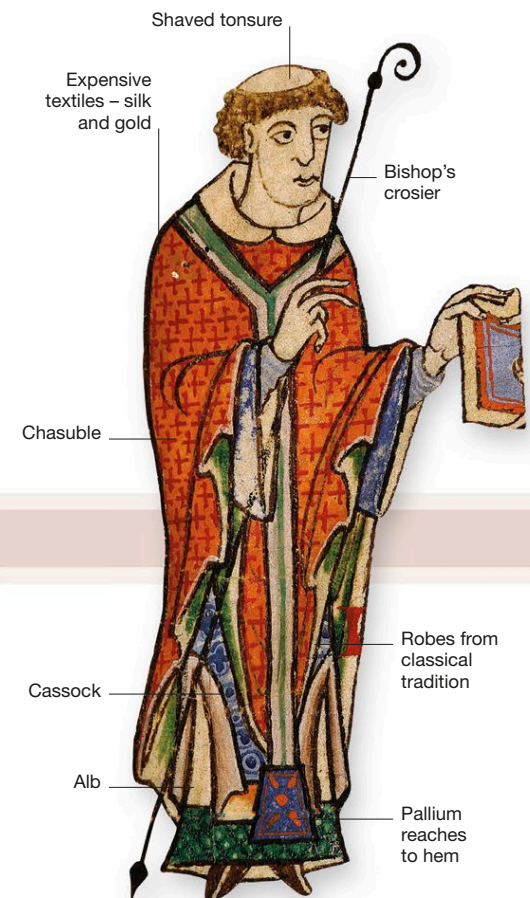
Syon Cope

Few pieces of medieval clothing are still in existence. Of those that survive, most are exceptionally high-quality mitres (bishop's hats), chasubles (vestments), and copes (semi-circular capes) made for the Church.

English church embroidery became famous as *opus anglicanum* (English work). It was the finest of its day and exported all over Europe. An exquisite example of this is the Syon Cope, made between 1300 and 1320. Precious metal threads mix with silk stitches to illustrate biblical stories, like a wearable illumination.



Pilgrim's clothing Pilgrims who set off to visit religious sites wore practical dress, including a hat to keep off the sun, robust woollen clothes to keep out wind and rain, a staff, and a leather satchel.



Bishop's robes Many of these 12th-century liturgical vestments are still worn today. A patterned red chasuble is worn over a blue cassock and white linen alb. A pallium (stole) drapes around his shoulders to the hem.